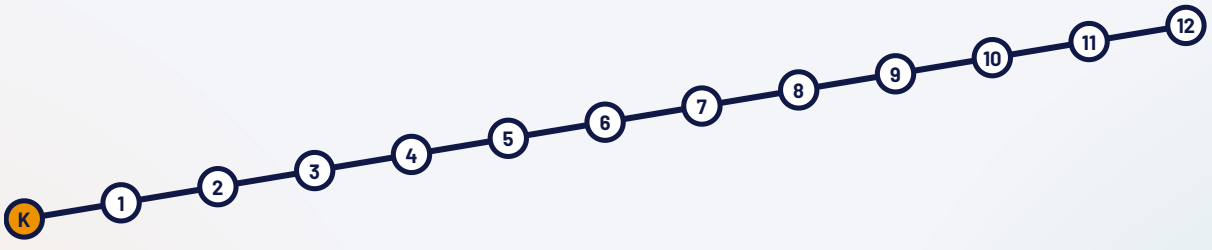
Awsaj Academy

K-12 VERTICAL ALIGNMENT · AN ANALYTICAL WALKTHROUGH

Our Curriculum Journey: Grades 9–12

What our teachers' ratings tell us about how our standards are taught, from Kindergarten to Grade 12, with questions and options for our part in the story.



These findings come from the ratings you entered as teachers. They show what teachers reported as taught across each grade (2,709 ratings, completed November 2026), not what students know or can do, and they do not judge any teacher. Every item links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

Contents

1	**High school, Grades 9-12** Grades 9 to 12, all four subjects.	**3**
2	**About the data (at the back)** Where the data comes from, how to read the ratings, the words we use, and the limits.	**17**

Each part follows the same path: the picture (charts), what the numbers say, what we notice, questions for us, and our part in the story (options for improving the curriculum, working across grade levels, knowing the bands above and below, and a concrete action). The data behind each item is shown in brackets, and each item links to the matching page of the Vertical Alignment site. About the data (where the data comes from, how to read the ratings, the words we use and the limits) is at the back. 20 pages, A4. The bookmarks jump to each part.

Taught in depth Introduced / exposed Not taught

HIGH SCHOOL, GRADES 9 TO 12

High school, Grades 9–12

In Grades 9-12, teachers reported that 63% of the 575 grade-level ratings (377 standards) are at least introduced, and 28% are taught in depth, the highest of the three bands. ELA (51%) and Science (48%) are both strong, and Grade 10 Science has the highest share in depth of any grade and subject (79%).

28%
taught in depth

63%
at least introduced

37%
not taught

575
grade-level ratings

What you are seeing. Four headline figures for this part: the share taught in depth, at least introduced and not taught, and how many ratings they come from.

What it adds to our story. This is the starting picture for this part. The slides that follow show where these numbers come from and what they might mean for us.

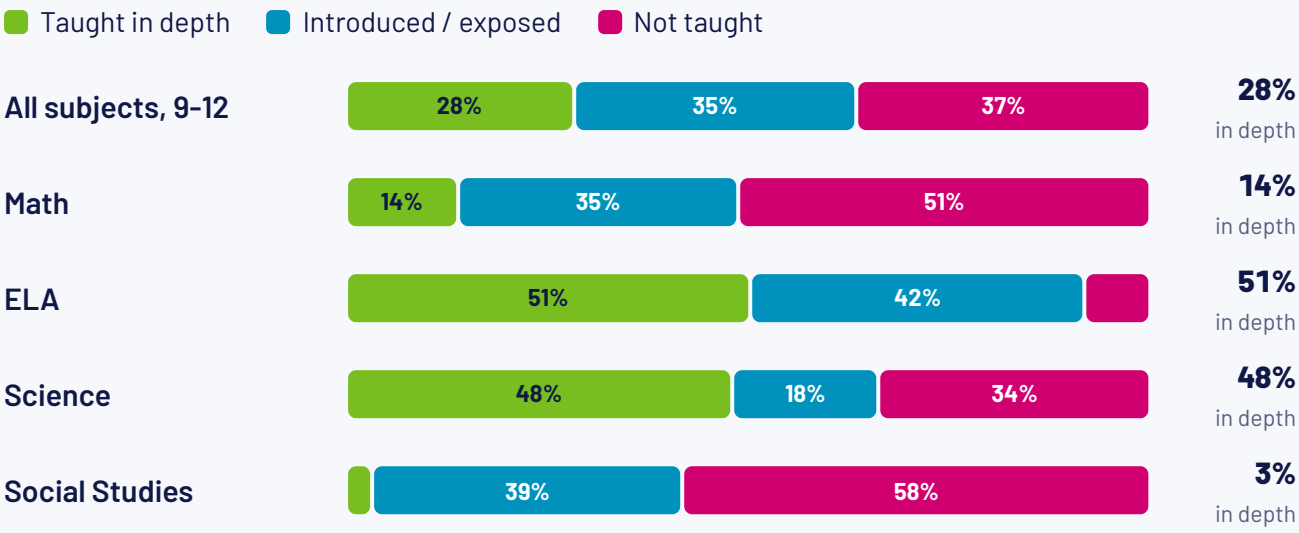
These findings come from the ratings you entered as teachers. They show what teachers reported as taught across each grade, not what students know or can do. We are sharing them back so we can see the whole picture together and decide how we move forward. Each part ends with options for our part in the story. Every item links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

THE PICTURE

At a glance

What you are seeing. Each bar shows all the ratings for one subject: green is taught in depth, blue is introduced, pink is not taught.

What it adds to our story. High school goes deepest of the three bands, led by ELA and Science.



How to read this: each bar is 100% of the grade-level ratings. Green is taught in depth, blue is introduced or exposed, pink is not taught. Essential Elements are counted apart.

Open the coverage map on the site ↗

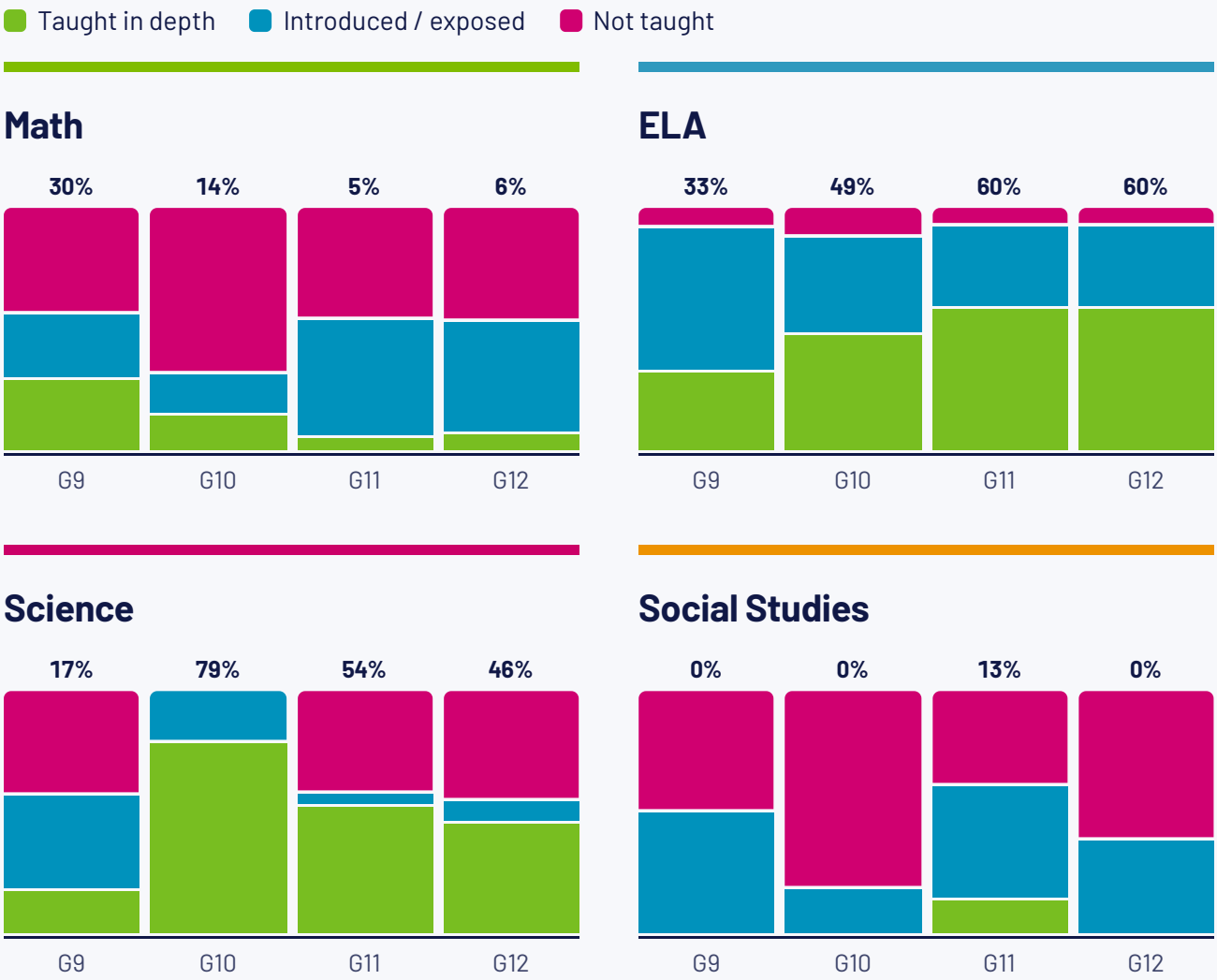
Share in depth	G9	G10	G11	G12	9-12
Math	30%	14%	5%	6%	14%
ELA	33%	49%	60%	60%	51%
Science	17%	79%	54%	46%	48%
Social Studies	0%	0%	13%	0%	3%
All subjects	24%	32%	34%	23%	28%

THE PICTURE

Grade by grade

What you are seeing. One column for each grade. The number on top is the share of that grade's standards taught in depth.

What it adds to our story. ELA builds year on year, and Math is strongest in Grade 9. The picture is mostly about choices between courses.



How to read this: for each subject, one column per grade, with the share taught in depth on top.

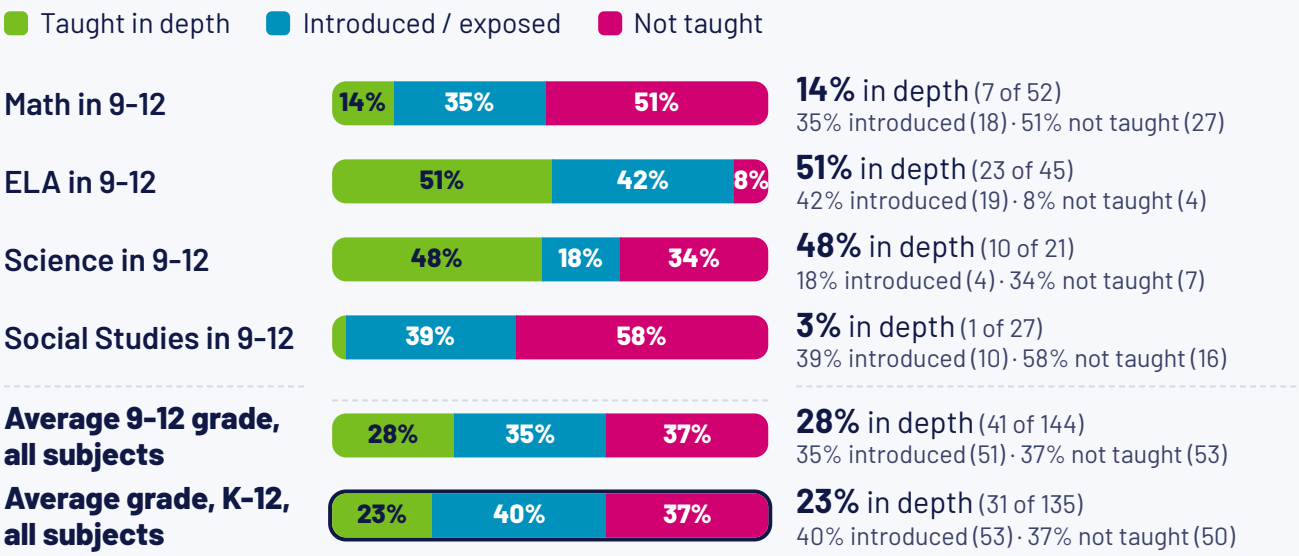
Open the grade dashboards ↗ Gaps and repetition ↗ Progressions ↗

THE PICTURE

Our curricular capacity

What you are seeing. Each bar is one average grade in a year: 100% of its grade-level standards, split into in depth, introduced and not taught, with the number of standards beside it. Each subject in the band, then the band average and, last, the school average (the average grade K-12, all subjects).

What it adds to our story. A 9-12 grade takes 28% of its grade-level standards to depth in a year (about 41 of 144), introduces 35% (51) and does not teach 37% (53). The average grade K-12, all subjects, takes 23% to depth (about 31 of 135).



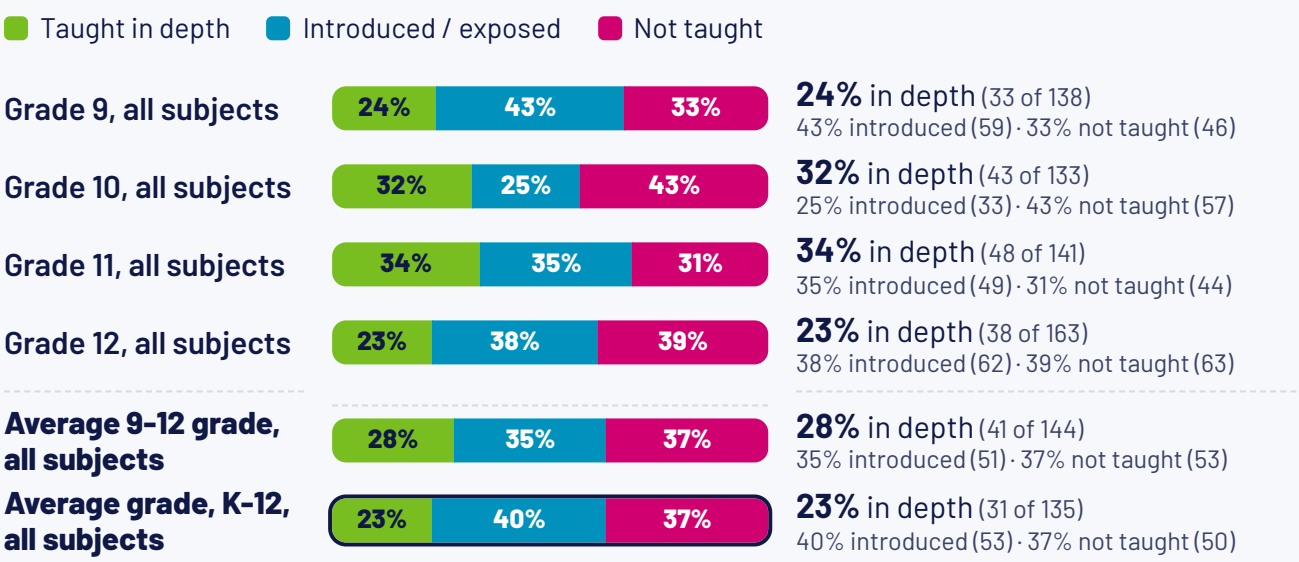
Curricular capacity: what a grade currently takes to depth, introduces and leaves untaught in a year, by its own teams' ratings of its grade-level standards (Wisconsin Common Core for Math and ELA; AERO, NGSS or Wisconsin for Science and Social Studies; not Essential Elements). Not a measure of teaching time, and not a target.

THE PICTURE

Our curricular capacity

What you are seeing. Each bar is one average grade in a year: 100% of its grade-level standards, split into in depth, introduced and not taught, with the number of standards beside it. Each grade in the band, all four subjects, then the band average and, last, the school average (the average grade K-12, all subjects).

What it adds to our story. A 9-12 grade takes 28% of its grade-level standards to depth in a year (about 41 of 144), introduces 35% (51) and does not teach 37% (53). The average grade K-12, all subjects, takes 23% to depth (about 31 of 135).





SECTION 1 OF 3

Facts

What you are seeing. The main facts from the ratings, in plain numbers. Each one links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

What it adds to our story. Few standards are missing everywhere. Most open questions are about which course teaches what.

Bright spots

Where teaching is strongest.

1. **ELA reaches almost everything.** 92% of ELA ratings are at least introduced, the highest coverage of any subject in any band. Only 14 of 180 ratings are not taught. Coverage map ↗
2. **Speaking and Listening is 100% in depth in Grades 11 and 12.** Reading is at 78% in both. Coverage map ↗
3. **Grade 10 Science.** 79% in depth and nothing rated not taught. All 15 Physical Science standards are in depth. Grade 10 dashboard ↗
4. **Grade 9 algebra is a strength.** Reasoning with Equations and Inequalities is 60% in depth in Grade 9, Creating Equations 50%, The Real Number System 100%. Coverage map ↗
5. **ELA builds year on year.** 33% in depth in Grade 9, 49% in Grade 10, 60% in Grades 11 and 12. Coverage map ↗
6. **Progressions.** In this band, 2 of 37 ELA, Math and Science progressions break down on an official link, and 21 of 29 ELA progressions are taught at every step. In the K-12 view, 2 Math progressions break down at Grade 9 and 3 Social Studies inquiry progressions stop after Grade 6. Progressions ↗

Gaps

Standards rated not taught by the grade they belong to, or where they were placed.

7. **Math strands with no standard rated in depth.** Trigonometric Functions, Similarity and Trigonometry, Conditional Probability, Making Inferences, Using Probability, Vectors and Matrices, Circles, Geometric Measurement, Building Functions, Linear, Quadratic and Exponential Models, and Expressing Geometric Properties (11 of 21 strands). Coverage map ↗

8. **Social Studies.** 3 of 106 ratings are in depth, all in Grade 11 Economics. Grade 10 rates 82% not taught. Coverage map ↗

9. **Hand-overs in.** 20 high school standards taught in depth build on an earlier-school standard rated not taught: ELA 9, Science 6, Math 3, Social Studies 2. Only the 3 in Math rest on official links; the others rest on suggested links, so each of those links is worth checking first. Progressions ↗

10. **Few confirmed gaps.** Only 7 standards are confirmed as not taught in any grade or course they belong to. A further 119 are rated not taught in the course where they fit best (Math 77, Social Studies 22, Science 20). Gaps and repetition ↗

Breadth without depth

Standards introduced widely but rarely taken to depth.

11. **Introduced, never in depth.** 128 standards are introduced and never in depth: Math 52, Social Studies 36, ELA 29, Science 11. Gaps and repetition ↗

Other notable

Other facts worth knowing.

12. **Math starts strong and thins.** 30% in depth in Grade 9, then 14%, 5% and 6%. Across the band, 51% of Math ratings are not taught. Grade 9 dashboard ↗

13. **The band in 3 numbers.** 162 ratings in depth (28%), 203 introduced (35%), 210 not taught (37%). Coverage map ↗

14. **Science strands.** Physical Science 88% in depth, Life Science 50%, Earth and Space 21%, Engineering 19%. Coverage map ↗

15. **Priority standards.** 38% of priority ratings are in depth, against 28% for all standards. Science 55%, ELA 54%, Math 27%, Social Studies 2%. Priority and power (Audit) ↗

16. **Math Essential Elements.** 54% of high school Math Essential Element ratings are not taught (32 of 59). Grade 12 Math rates 64 standards, level with Social Studies in each of Grades 6, 7 and 8 as the most of any grade and subject. Grade 12 dashboard ↗



SECTION 2 OF 3

Patterns

What you are seeing. What we notice when we put the facts side by side: rises, dips and comparisons. These are possibilities to talk about, not conclusions.

What it adds to our story. ELA's steady, planned sequence goes with high depth, and the SAT areas in Math deserve a closer look.

Trends across the grades

How things rise, fall or alternate from grade to grade.

1. **ELA and Math move in opposite directions.** ELA depth nearly doubles from Grade 9 to Grade 12 (33% to 60%). Math depth falls from 30% to 6% over the same years. Coverage map ↗

Handoffs

What passes between grades and between schools.

2. **Strong Physical Science sits on thin foundations.** Six high school Science standards taught in depth build, on suggested links, on K-5 standards rated not taught by their own K-5 grade. Five of those are Physical Science. Coverage map ↗

3. **Grades 9 and 10 build; Grades 11 and 12 match exactly.** Grades 9 and 10 rate the same 43 ELA standards but agree on only 18: Grade 9 introduces and Grade 10 deepens, like a two-year sequence. Grades 11 and 12 gave identical ratings on all 47 shared standards (28 in depth in both), which is worth confirming. Coverage map ↗

4. **Grade 9 is a landing year.** ELA falls from 50% in Grade 8 to 33%, and Science from 43% to 17%, while Math rises from 0% to 30%. Grade 9 Writing is at 15% against 77% in Grade 10. Coverage map ↗

Language and literacy

Where language and literacy are taught, and how.

5. **Language is the thinnest ELA strand again.** 30% in depth, against 54% to 69% for the other strands. It is also the thinnest strand in K-5 (10%). Coverage map ↗

6. **Science and Social Studies carry literacy too.** High school Science (48% in depth) uses reading, data and argument writing that ELA standards describe. Social Studies inquiry (all 10 standards not taught in Grades 9 and 10) may be close to the research ELA teaches in depth. Coverage map ↗

Essential Elements

Where much teaching may happen at the level students are at.

7. **Essential Elements in Social Studies outpace the main standards.** 22% in depth against 3%. In Science they are also slightly ahead (55% against 48%). Coverage map ↗

Choices and capacity

What a grade can carry in a year, and what we choose.

8. **Priority Math is deepest in Grades 9 and 10.** In Grade 9, 75% of priority Math standards are in depth, and in Grade 10, 41%. In Grades 11 and 12 the figure is 13% and 9%. Priority and power (Audit) ↗

9. **Some standards are not taught in the course where they fit.** High school Math, Science and Social Studies standards were each placed in the course where they fit best. 119 of them are rated not taught in that course. Each course team can say which of these it plans to take on and which it leaves out on purpose. Gaps and repetition ↗

10. **Science depth follows the course map.** Grade 10 is Physical Science (100% in depth), Grade 11 is Life Science (50%), Grade 9 is Earth and Space (21%). Grade 9 is the quietest Science year at 17%. Coverage map ↗

11. **Capacity shows what a high school grade carries in a year.** A high school grade takes about 41 standards to depth across its four subjects (about 10 per subject), introduces about 51 and does not teach about 53, out of about 144 rated. By subject, per grade: ELA about 23 in depth of 45 rated, Science 10 of 21, Math 7 of 52, Social Studies 1 of 27. As shares of each subject's ratings: ELA 51% in depth, 42% introduced, 8% not taught; Math 14% in depth, 35% introduced, 51% not taught; Science 48% in depth, 18% introduced, 34% not taught; Social Studies 3% in depth, 39% introduced, 58% not taught. Capacity here means what a grade currently reports taking to depth, introducing or not teaching in a year. It is not a target and not a judgement. Coverage map ↗

Toward the SAT

What the ratings suggest about readiness for the SAT.

12. **The Math taught most in depth is algebra, a large part of SAT Math.** Grade 9 equations and functions are the strongest part of high school Math. The SAT's other areas are thinner: data and statistics strands are at or near 0%, and geometry and trigonometry sit under 10% apart from Congruence (31%). Grade 9 dashboard ↗

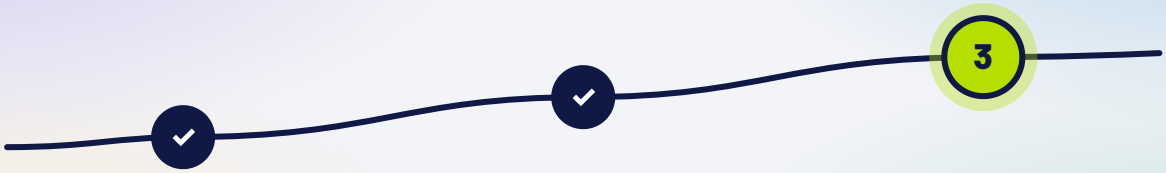
Other notable

Other facts worth knowing.

13. **High school is our most settled band.** It has the highest share in depth, the fewest confirmed gaps (7, with a further 119 standards not taught in the course where they fit) and the fewest ELA and Science breaks. The picture here is less about holes and more about choices between courses. Gaps and repetition ↗

14. **Social Studies inquiry is rated not taught in Grades 9 and 10.** All 10 Inquiry standards are rated not taught in both Grade 9 and Grade 10. Grade 9 Geography is the exception in coverage: 92% introduced. Coverage map ↗

Section 3: Moving forward



Facts · Patterns · Moving forward (YOU ARE HERE)

SECTION 3 OF 3

Moving forward

What you are seeing. Questions for teams to talk about. Each one shows the data that prompted it, and links to where that figure appears on this page.

What it adds to our story. These questions are about the end of the journey: what every graduate should leave with.

Improving the curriculum

What to teach, deepen, place or leave out.

1. **Which Math standards do our students most need for the SAT and the diploma, and are those the ones we take to depth?**

   (Data: 14% of high school Math is in depth: algebra strands about 28%, data analysis about 3%, geometry and trigonometry about 7%) see Pattern 11

   Coverage map ↗

2. **Data, statistics and probability have almost no depth in high school Math: is that a decision, and does it match what the SAT asks?**

   (Data: 1 of 38 ratings in depth across the 4 statistics and probability strands) see At a glance chart

   Coverage map ↗

3. **Where could Social Studies inquiry skills be taught alongside the research and argument writing ELA already does in depth?**

   (Data: All 10 Inquiry standards are not taught in Grades 9 and 10; ELA Reading is 61% and Writing 54% in depth) see Fact 15

   Coverage map ↗

4 **For the 77 Math standards not taught in the course where they fit, which should that course start teaching, and which have we chosen to leave out?**

(Data: 51% of high school Math ratings are not taught, with no confirmed gaps) see Fact 12

Gaps and repetition ↗

5 **For the 119 standards not taught in the course where they fit, which should each course take on, and who decides?**

(Data: 119 standards not taught in the course where they fit: Math 77, Social Studies 22, Science 20) see Fact 10

Gaps and repetition ↗

Working across grade levels

Grades and teams comparing and planning together.

6 **What lets ELA build so steadily from Grade 9 to Grade 12, and how is that sequence agreed between teachers?**

(Data: ELA in depth 33%, 49%, 60%, 60%; 21 of 29 progressions taught at every step) see Fact 5

Progressions ↗

7 **Which one Grade 12 standard per subject should every graduate reach in depth, and which grade first takes it there?**

(Data: Grade 12 in depth: ELA 60%, Science 46%, Math 6%, Social Studies 0%) see Pattern 1

Coverage map ↗

8 **Grade 9 priority Math is strong: what would it take to carry that into Grades 10 to 12?**

(Data: Priority Math in depth: 75% in Grade 9, 41% in Grade 10, 13% in Grade 11, 9% in Grade 12) see Pattern 8

Priority and power (Audit) ↗

Knowing the bands above and below

What the next grade or school relies on.

9 **What would help Grade 9 feel less like a restart in ELA and Science?**

(Data: Grade 8 to Grade 9, ELA 50% to 33% and Science 43% to 17%; Grade 9 Writing is 15% in depth) see Pattern 4

Coverage map ↗

10 **What should middle school know about what high school finds on arrival?**

(Data: 20 high school standards in depth build on an earlier-school standard rated not taught: ELA 9, Science 6, Math 3, Social Studies 2) see Fact 9

Progressions ↗

11 **Which K-5 and middle school Physical Science ideas does Grade 10 wish students arrived with?**

(Data: All 15 Grade 10 Physical Science standards are in depth; 5 build, on suggested links, on K-5 Physical Science standards not taught in their own grade) see Fact 3

Gaps and repetition ↗

How we rate and plan How we read the scale and plan our time.

12 **Is Language (grammar, usage, vocabulary) taught through writing in high school, and would teams rate it differently if so?**

(Data: Language is 30% in depth, against 54% to 69% for the other ELA strands) see Pattern 5

Coverage map ↗

13 **Knowing a high school grade takes about 41 standards to depth a year, are those the standards our graduates most need, including for the SAT?**

(Data: Per grade in 9-12: about 41 in depth, 51 introduced, 53 not taught, out of 144 rated) see Pattern 11

Coverage map ↗

14 **Which high school standards are we choosing to leave out, and is that choice written down for each course?**

(Data: 9-12 mix: 28% in depth, 35% introduced, 37% not taught) see Fact 13

Coverage map ↗

Our part in the story

What you are seeing. Options for what we could do, under four headings, each with the data behind it.

What it adds to our story. This is where findings turn into action: small, shared steps we could take together.

Options to discuss and act on. Pick what fits your team, change it, or add your own.

Improving the curriculum

In high school, we could agree, course by course, which standards each course owns and which it leaves out on purpose.

(Data: 119 standards not taught in the course where they fit: Math 77, Social Studies 22, Science 20) see Fact 10

Gaps and repetition ↗

Working across grade levels

We might ask Grade 8 and Grade 9 teachers in ELA and Science to plan the first unit of Grade 9 together.

(Data: Grade 8 to Grade 9: ELA 50% to 33%, Science 43% to 17%) see Pattern 4

Coverage map ↗

Knowing the bands above and below

From high school Math, we could share with middle school the 5 algebra ideas Grade 9 relies on most.

(Data: 3 Grade 9 Math standards in depth build on Grade 6 and Grade 8 standards rated not taught)

Progressions ↗

A concrete action we could take

We might map high school Math against the SAT areas and choose which thin strands to deepen first.

(Data: Algebra about 28% in depth; data analysis about 3%; geometry and trigonometry about 7%) see Fact 13

Coverage map ↗

WHERE THE NUMBERS COME FROM AND HOW TO READ THEM

About the data

This paper walks through what our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, from Kindergarten to Grade 12. It has eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands, and the four subjects. Each part has three sections: Facts, Patterns, and Moving forward (questions for teams to take forward, and options for our part in the story).

> **These findings come from the ratings you entered as teachers.** They show what teachers reported as taught across each grade, not what students know or can do. We are sharing them back so we can see the whole picture together and decide how we move forward. Each part ends with options for our part in the story. Every item links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

ABOUT THE DATA

How to read this paper

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

This paper walks through what our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, from Kindergarten to Grade 12. It has eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands, and the four subjects. Each part has three sections: Facts, Patterns, and Moving forward (questions for teams to take forward, and options for our part in the story).

Where the numbers come from. Every figure is computed from the ratings sheet of 9 November 2026 (2,166 standards, 2,709 ratings, last rating 8 November) and checked against the Vertical Alignment reports and findings decks.

The three ratings.

Rating	What it means
Taught in depth	ALL classes in the grade consistently teach, reteach, review and assess the standard
Introduced / exposed	Anything in between: some classes, or taught briefly (for example, 3 of 5 classes)

Rating	What it means
Not taught	No class in the grade teaches it

Four things to hold in mind while reading.

- The ratings are what teachers reported as taught across a whole grade. They are not a measure of what students know or can do, and they do not judge any teacher.
- "In depth" is all or nothing. Teams may have read that more or less strictly, so a low figure can reflect a stricter reading, not less teaching. Where this matters most, the paper says so. Where a team rated none of its standards in depth, we read it as careful use of an all-or-nothing scale, not as an absence of teaching.
- Each team rated its own subject's standards. Much literacy (vocabulary, academic language, speaking, writing, reading non-fiction) is also taught through Science and Social Studies, and that teaching may not show in the ELA ratings.
- Shares are of the main grade-level ratings (one standard in one grade). Essential Elements (the alternate standards) are counted apart.

We cannot teach everything equally. No school can take every standard to depth, and that is not the goal. The goal is to choose on purpose: which standards we teach in depth, which we introduce, and which we leave out, and to plan that proportion together across the grades. The ratings show the mix we have now, so we can decide the mix we want.

Curricular capacity. How many standards a grade reports taking to depth, introducing or leaving out in a year, worked out from the ratings (the average for one grade). It is not a target and not a judgement: it describes the mix we report now, so we can decide together how to use it.

Categories. In every part, each section groups its items under the same categories, in the same order, so a team can follow one kind of observation across the whole school, its band and its subject. Facts: Bright spots, Gaps, Breadth without depth, Anomalies and Other notable. Patterns: Trends across the grades, Handoffs, Language and literacy, Essential Elements, How we rated, Choices and capacity, Toward the SAT and Other notable. Moving forward: Improving the curriculum, Working across grade levels, Knowing the bands above and below, and How we rate and plan. A category with nothing in it is left out.

How each part is laid out. Three sections, each opening with a small map that shows where you are: Facts, then Patterns, then Moving forward (questions to ponder, then options for our part in the story: improving the curriculum, working across grade levels, knowing the bands above and below, and a concrete action). Every pattern carries its figures in the text, and every question ends with the data behind it, in brackets and italics. The questions are invitations, not conclusions. Our strengths are named alongside the places where we might build.

ABOUT THE DATA

Method, sources and limits

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

Every figure in this paper was computed from the ratings sheet and cross-checked against the site. Where the site's band and K-12 views differ (progressions), the paper says which it uses. Percentages are rounded half up, as on the site.

What was read

Source	How it was used	How fully it was read
Ratings sheet, "All Standards and Ratings K-12" (9 Nov 2026)	Every figure	All 2,166 rows
Organized ratings workbook	Cross-check of totals	All tabs
20 Findings decks (band and subject)	Cross-check, questions and next-step themes	All slides and speaker notes
K-12 Reports PDF (118 pages)	Cross-check	First 80 pages scanned by search; a few read directly
7 other Reports PDFs	Cross-check of headline figures	Scanned by search, not read page by page

How terms are used

- **Rated standards.** One rating is one standard in one grade. A standard shared by several grades is counted once for each grade that rated it.
- **At least introduced.** Rated in depth or introduced.
- **Not taught where it belongs (confirmed).** The grade the standard belongs to rated it not taught (for a standard shared across grades, every grade that shares it did). In Math and ELA each standard belongs to one grade, so this means that grade's team rated it not taught; it does not mean other grades should have taught it.
- **Not taught where it fits.** Each standard was placed in the grade or course where it fits best, and that grade or course rated it not taught. Other grades were not asked to rate it.
- **Introduced, never in depth (met but not owned).** Introduced in at least one grade and in depth in none.
- **Progression finding.** An automatic check on a chain of linked standards: a step not taught, or a standard in depth while the one it builds on is not taught.

- **Taught at every step.** Every standard in the chain, across two or more grades, is at least introduced.
- **Progression.** A chain of linked standards across grades. Official links are the Coherence Map (Math), anchor standards (ELA) and the standards' own structure (Science, Social Studies). Other links are suggestions.
- **Curricular capacity.** The average number of standards one grade rated in depth, introduced and not taught in a year (all ratings divided by the number of grades), rounded.
- **Hand-over gap.** A standard taught in depth while a standard it builds on, placed in an earlier school, is rated not taught.
- **Priority and power standards.** Standards the school's own documents name: power standards in K-5, priority standards in 6-12.

Limits to keep in view

- Ratings are teachers' judgements of teaching across a grade. They are not observations and not student results.
- Grades may have read "in depth" differently. Uniform ratings across a whole grade are a reason to check how the scale was read; the paper points these out so teams can discuss them.
- The ratings are what teachers reported as taught. They do not measure what students know or can do.
- Each team rated its own subject. Literacy taught in Science and Social Studies, and Math taught in Science, may not show in the ELA and Math ratings.
- Middle school Science and high school Math, Science and Social Studies standards were placed in the grade or course where each fits best. 24 K-5 Social Studies standards are also rated not taught in the grade where they fit.
- Band counts of progressions look only at steps inside the band, so they do not add up to the K-12 figure.
- Literacy audit figures come from the 2026 PK-5 literacy audit of weekly plans.
- Some strands have few standards in a grade, so a single rating can move a percentage a long way. Counts are given where this matters.
- Suggested links between standards (most ELA, Science and Social Studies hand-overs) have not been checked by teachers.

Status. This is a draft for the Vertical Alignment Committee. Each finding should be checked with the teams concerned before it is treated as settled. The planned review of weekly and unit plans (Part 2) will test many of these patterns against what is actually planned.